FAMILY AND SOCIETY IN ISLAM

FACULTY OF ISLAMIC STUDIES

GENERAL EDUCATION

DIHPE - DOW UNIVERSITY OF HEALTH SCIENCES (DUHS)

LECTURE# 5

PART (I)

STATUS AND RIGHTS OF WOMEN IN ISLAMIC TEACHINGS

- Islam brought a revolutionary transformation to the condition of women in pre-Islamic Arabia, where they were largely viewed as subhuman, denied inheritance, education, and basic human dignity. Through the Quran and the exemplary life of Prophet Muhammad (SAW), women were granted spiritual, social, legal, and economic rights.

Allah stated in Surah Al-Nisa verse 1:

"O people! Fear your Lord Who created you from a single soul and made its mate from within it, and from that pair spread many men and women and fear Allah in Whose name you ask for (your rights) and pay attention to the ties of relationship. Undoubtedly. Allah is watching you all time"



SPIRITUAL AND RELIGIOUS EQUALITY

The Qur’an emphasizes that both men and women are equally accountable for their actions and will be rewarded or punished based on their deeds, not their gender:

- "Every soul will be (held) in pledge for its deeds." (Surah Al-Muddathir - Verse 38)
- "Whoever does good, whether male or female, and is a believer, We will surely bless them with a good life, and We will certainly reward them according to the best of their deeds." (Surah An-Nahl - Verse 97)

- These verses show that men and women stand equal before Allah in terms of faith, responsibilities, and rewards. Women perform religious duties such as prayer, fasting, Hajj, and Zakah just like men, with minor exemptions related to their natural biological functions such as menstruation and childbirth.

STATUS OF WOMEN IN ISLAM

Introduction:

- In pre-Islamic Arabia, women were considered part of wealth and property, bought and sold like commodities. They were often seen as a source of bad luck and misfortune, leading to practices such as burying innocent girls alive. Those who survived faced severe oppression and hardship.

Transformation Brought by Islam:

- The Holy Prophet Muhammad (SAW) revolutionized the status of women through divine revelations and his exemplary life. Islam granted women equal rights, honor, and status in life, acknowledging their importance as individuals and members of society.

WOMEN AS DAUGHTERS

1. Daughters as a Mercy and Blessing

a. Daughters Are a Gift from Allah

- Allah condemns parents who feel sad at the birth of a daughter. Allah declares that children are a gift, whether sons or daughters: “To Allah belongs the dominion of the heavens and the earth. He creates what He wills. He gives to whom He wills female [children], and He gives to whom He wills males.” (Surah Ash-Shura, Verse:49)

This verse establishes that having daughters is a part of Allah’s divine wisdom and mercy.

b. Elimination of Pre-Islamic Practice of Killing Daughters

- Islam strongly condemned female infanticide, a cruel practice common in pre-Islamic Arabia: “And when the girl [who was] buried alive is asked. For what sin she was killed.” (Surah At-Takwir, Verse:8–9)

This powerful condemnation reflects Islam’s protection of the life and dignity of girls.

WOMEN AS DAUGHTERS

2. Prophet Muhammad ﷺ and His Love for Daughters

The Holy Prophet (SAW) called daughters a blessing from Almighty Allah. The Prophet Muhammad ﷺ had four daughters, including Fatimah (RA), whom he loved dearly. He treated her with utmost respect and affection:

“Fatimah is a part of me. Whoever hurts her, hurts me.” (Sahih al-Bukhari)

“When Fatimah would enter, the Prophet ﷺ would stand up to greet her, kiss her, and seat her in his place.” (Sunan Abi Dawud)

This shows the honor and high regard Islam gives to daughters.

The Prophet’s (SAW) love for his youngest daughter, Hazrat Fatima (RA), serves as a model of parental affection and respect.

WOMEN AS DAUGHTERS

3. Reward for Raising Daughters with Love and Care

a. Protection from Hellfire: “Whoever has three daughters, and he accommodates them, shows mercy toward them, and supports them, Paradise is guaranteed for him.” (Sunan al-Tirmidhi)

b. Even with two daughters, this reward applies: “Whoever takes care of two daughters until they reach maturity, he and I will come on the Day of Judgment like this, and he joined his fingers together”. (Sahih Muslim)

This Hadith shows the immense reward and virtue of raising daughters with kindness and patience.

The Prophet (SAW) encouraged giving gifts to daughters first and emphasized their loving nature towards parents.

WOMEN AS DAUGHTERS

4. Rights of Daughters in Islam

a. Right to Life and Protection

Islam abolishes harmful cultural practices and guarantees a daughter's right to live, grow, and thrive. Islamic law emphasizes parental care and attention, especially for girls.

b. Right to Education

The Prophet ﷺ said: "Seeking knowledge is obligatory on every Muslim." (Sunan Ibn Majah) This includes girls equally, as knowledge is essential for their development and contribution to society.

c. Right to Respect and Love

Daughters must be raised with respect, not shame or regret. Islam promotes kind treatment, emotional support, and equal love for all children.

d. Right to Marriage Choice and Inheritance

Daughters have the right to choose their spouse (with family guidance) and receive a fair share of inheritance as per Islamic law (Surah An-Nisa, Verse: 7, 11).

WOMEN AS WIVES

1. The Foundation of Marriage in Islam

“And among His signs is that He created for you from yourselves mates that you may find tranquility in them, and He placed between you affection and mercy…” (Surah Ar-Rum, Verse:21)

This verse beautifully describes the essence of marriage as a relationship based on peace (sukoon), love (mawaddah), and mercy (rahmah).

The Quran also states: “They are garments for you, and you are garments for them.” (Surah Al-Baqarah, Verse:187)

Just like garments protect and beautify, spouses provide comfort, protection, and dignity to one another.

WOMEN AS WIVES

2. The Example of the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ as a Husband

The Prophet ﷺ was a perfect example of a loving and respectful husband. He said:

“The best of you are those who are best to their wives, and I am the best of you to my wives.” (Sunan al-Tirmidhi)

He was always pleasant, kind, cheerful, and affectionate with his wives. He emphasized that women are a trust from Allah, and kindness toward them is a sign of true faith.

“Fear Allah regarding women. You have taken them as a trust from Allah…” (Sahih Muslim)

The Holy Prophet (SAW) was an exemplary husband, declaring the best believer as one who is good to his wife.

WOMEN AS WIVES

3. The Rights of Wives in Islam

Islam grants wives various legal, financial, emotional, and spiritual rights, including:

a. Right to Mahr (Bridal Gift) “And give the women (upon marriage) their bridal gifts graciously…” (Surah An-Nisa, Verse:4)

b. b. Right to Maintenance (Nafaqah)

A wife has the right to shelter, clothing, and food from her husband, regardless of her own financial status.

c. Right to Respectful Treatment “…And live with them in kindness…” (Surah An-Nisa, Verse:19)

Husbands are instructed to live with their wives honorably and respectfully, not as masters but as loving companions.

d. Right to Equality in Marriage “And women have rights similar to those of men over them in kindness…” (Surah Al-Baqarah, Verse:228)

This verse asserts the balanced and reciprocal rights between husbands and wives, emphasizing mutual respect and justice.

WOMEN AS WIVES

4. Justice in Polygamy

Islam permits a man to marry up to four wives, but only under strict conditions of justice and fairness: “…then marry those that please you of [other] women, two or three or four. But if you fear that you will not be just, then [marry only] one…” (Surah An-Nisa, Verse:3)

This permission comes with a clear warning: without complete equality and justice, polygamy is discouraged.

WOMEN AS WIVES

5. Responsibilities of Wives in Islam

While Islam grants many rights to wives, it also encourages them to:

1. Cooperate with their husbands in what is right
2. Maintain the honor, privacy, and dignity of the home
3. Provide emotional support and companionship
4. Help raise pious and morally upright children

“Therefore, the righteous women are devoutly obedient, and guard in the husband's absence what Allah would have them guard…” (Surah An-Nisa, Verse:34)

WOMEN AS MOTHERS

1.High Status of Mothers in Islam

a. Qur’anic Respect for Mothers

"And We have enjoined upon man [care] for his parents. His mother carried him, [increasing her] in weakness upon weakness, and his weaning is in two years. Be grateful to Me and to your parents; to Me is the [final] destination."

(Surah Luqman, Verse:14)

- This verse emphasizes the importance of gratitude towards both God and parents. It highlights the physical hardship and emotional endurance a mother goes through during pregnancy and breastfeeding. The verse concludes by reminding us that our ultimate return is to Allah, who will judge us on how we treated our parents.
- The mother is mentioned first to stress her sacrifice, and scholars have pointed out that this verse sets the foundation of moral family relations.

WOMEN AS MOTHERS

b. Hadith: Paradise Lies at the Feet of Mothers

“Paradise lies under the feet of your mother.” (Mishkat al-Masabih)

This Hadith is one of the most powerful affirmations of a mother’s rank. Serving one’s mother with love and humility is seen as a path to Jannah (Paradise).

WOMEN AS MOTHERS

2. Mothers' Rights over Children

a. Obedience and Kind Treatment

"Say not to them [parents] a word of disrespect, nor shout at them, but address them in terms of honor." (Surah Al-Isra, Verse:23)

Islam prohibits even the smallest form of disrespect ("uff") toward parents, especially mothers, and instructs children to speak to them with honor and kindness.

WOMEN AS MOTHERS

b. Priority in Kindness

A man asked the Prophet ﷺ "Who among people is most deserving of my good company?"

He replied: "Your mother."

He asked, "Then who?"

The Prophet said: "Your mother."

He asked again, "Then who?"

He said: "Your mother."

He asked, "Then who?"

The Prophet said: "Then your father." (Sahih al-Bukhari & Sahih Muslim)

- It is narrated that obedience to one's mother earns the reward equal to one accepted Hajj and disrespecting her is considered a major sin.
- Serving one's mother is not a voluntary act; it is a religious duty and even preferred over voluntary jihad, as the Prophet ﷺ stated in several narrations.

❖ This Hadith shows that mothers hold a status three times greater than that of fathers in terms of companionship and kindness.

WOMEN AS MOTHERS

3. Role and Responsibilities of Mothers in Islam

a. First School of a Child “Every child is born in a state of fitrah (natural disposition of belief in One God), but it is his parents who make him a Jew, Christian, or Magian.” (Sahih Muslim)

b. The mother is seen as the first educator. Her actions, speech, and character deeply influence the spiritual and moral formation of the child.

WOMEN AS MOTHERS

b. Nurturer of Faith and Morality

A mother plays a vital role in:

Instilling faith (Iman)

Developing character (Akhlaq)

Teaching love for the Qur’an and Sunnah

Creating an atmosphere of Islamic values in the home

c. The Prophet’s ﷺ Example

The Prophet Muhammad ﷺ showed great respect for his own mothers, including his foster mother Hazrat Halima Sa’diyyah (RA).
He would stand in her presence, spread his cloak for her to sit, and speak to her with utmost love.
This demonstrates that love and gratitude should be extended not only to biological mothers but also to those who fulfill the role of a mother.

WOMEN AS MOTHERS

4. Financial and Social Protection

Islam ensures that mothers receive dignity, security, and care, both socially and financially:

1. Right to maintenance (nafaqah) during marriage.
2. Custody of children after divorce (under specified Islamic legal conditions).
3. Entitled to inheritance as outlined in Surah An-Nisa.
4. After death, children are encouraged to:Make Du’a
5. Give charity (sadaqah)
6. Do good deeds in their name, which benefit the mother in the Hereafter.

CONCLUSION

Islamic teachings honor women's rights and responsibilities spiritually, socially, and economically, advocating for their dignity and respect in all aspects of life. Women are seen as equal partners to men, with roles that complement each other, ensuring a balanced and harmonious society. Islam transformed the status of women, granting them rights, honor, and dignity. Women hold esteemed positions as daughters, wives, and mothers, each role carrying significant responsibilities and rewards. The teachings of the Holy Prophet (SAW) and the Quran provide a comprehensive guide for the respectful and equitable treatment of women, ensuring their rightful place in society.

THANK YOU